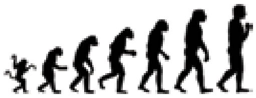


enough to keep AI away from nuclear armament control, so don't worry), etc.

In the entertainment industry, gaming is one area that's seeing large application of AI programming. It's no longer enough for the consumer to play games in which the enemy's moves are predictable. AI in Game Programming ensures that the enemy becomes challenging and lifelike when playing against. For example, if you've cornered an artificially intelligent enemy he wouldn't simply continue fighting. He'd use a different strategy against you – maybe pretend to die, wait for you to get close and then waste you with a head shot (This behaviour would be based upon your in-game behaviour of spray-painting enemies with your symbol or name).

A degree in Software Programming, more specifically Game Programming, should nicely land you a plum, futuristic job.

Another geek-favourite application of AI Programming would be in the field of Robotics – introducing to us the futuristic job of Robotics Scientist. Robotics has applications in a plethora of areas, limited only by our imagination (think: nanobots). If this branch of technology excites you, then you should definitely plan for a Masters degree in Robotics Engineering.

Facial Recognition is another area where artificial intelligence can be useful. Everyone, from commercial enterprises to the government and law enforcement needs this person identification/verification system. The tech has gone beyond recognition of geometrical patterns of a person's face and is now able to determine age and whether he's in disguise, among other things.

It doesn't take a genius to perform searches on the internet, but this wasn't the case a few years ago. We are where we are today mainly due to artificially intelligent software that determine what you're actually searching for even though you dont type in the right keywords. In the future, the search engine will give you results for terms before you even think about searching for them. This is possible since the AI of the search engine would have determined what you were working on based on your previous search and given you results based on what it might have thought is useful to your project. A Ph.D in AI is the way to go if you want to be a search engine AI developer.

At the end of the day, the biggest employers of AI will be the government and the military. This is because data explosion is making it simply impossible for government-employed human operators to classify and sort data – this is where 'thinking' computer systems come to the rescue. As for the military, AI will be involved in sorting out defense intelligence from the data it receives and in the use of smart weapons and gear. If you want to work with the government or military, you'll need to study Software Engineering with a focus on AI.

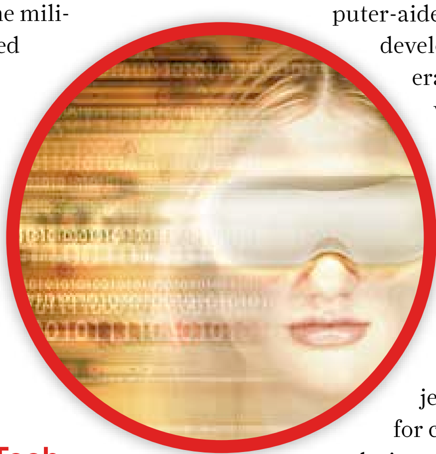
Virtual Reality Tech Support

It's every geek's dream to one day see the holodeck become a reality. For the moment, we seem to be light years away from that dream but we're definitely racing towards it.

Virtual Reality (VR) – or Virtual Environment (VE) as the scientists of today prefer to call it – is a computer-generated environment that simulates a real-world environment or an imagined one and gives the feeling of being physically present in that place. A VR system can simulate visuals, sounds, smells, touch, etc. Currently, a virtual reality experience is delivered through displays on screens or through special headsets that give the feeling of being immersed in the environment.

The technology has application in Education, Medicine, Military, Government, Entertainment, etc. Its usage is only limited by our imagination. It's undoubtedly one of the technologies that will become prominent in the near future. Currently, there's a shortage of VR specialists who can function as tech support and hence this promises to be one of the lucrative career choices of the future. The range of issues solvable by a VR tech support would range from correcting VR environment errors to actually immersing themselves into the VR environment to help out a customer stuck at some point in the VR simulation.

Depending on the area of the VR application, educational qualification here would bestow you with a mix of skills. Some of the subjects you'll need to study would be digital modelling, computer-aided design, software development, transgenerational design, virtual environments, cyberpsychology, morphing signals, artificial intelligence, vision and cultural studies, and spatial culture. Considering the diversity of the subjects, it's best to enroll for courses specifically designed for Virtual Reality.



A number of foreign universities are beginning to include such courses.

Dream Specialist

Here's something for *Inception* fans – a job in dream specialism. This is one of those careers that might take off with a bang once neuroscientists perfect the art of enabling a person to control his/her dreams (lucid dreaming). Stimulating the brain during sleep with specific electrical frequencies makes you self-aware inside your dreams. Imagine the possibilities! In the future, however, the job of a Dream